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« I've already achieved things that not all the greats have achieved »

NOAH LYLES

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Even though he competes in the sprints — one of the few events in track and field that has never suffered a shortage of outspoken personalities — Noah Lyles stands out as someone who is probably the brashest of his generation.

He enters the track with flamboyant pre-race routines and Yu-Gi-Oh cards, wins races wearing fingernail polish, a glitzy, multicoloured chain-link necklace and *Dragon Ball Z* socks, and celebrates his victories by cheekily calling out giant American domestic sports leagues for their claims of being 'world' champions.

He is more than just a flashy personality, though. Lyles is the reigning Olympic 100m champion, and a couple of months ago, he won

a fourth consecutive gold medal in the 200m at the World Championships to become the only man, apart from a certain Usain Bolt, to accomplish the feat.

Lyles is a long way from his element in Pune, where he is flagging off the Bajaj Pune Marathon last Sunday. He thinks he was in high school the last time he ran any race longer than a minute. Yet the longer race brings out a more contemplative American.

Ahead of the event, Lyles speaks to *Sportstar* about how he views his legacy, the accomplishments that mean the most to him, and the vulnerabilities his personality hides.

You are here in India to flag off a marathon. What's the longest you've ever run yourself?

The longest I've ever run has

probably been about four miles. It's what we used to do for conditioning in high school. Between November and December, we would come for practice, and our coach would say, 'Go run four miles.' We had different routes — triangle, square and circle. The triangle was three miles, the square was four miles, and the circle was about five kilometres or so.

I hated running those four miles. It's just too boring. My ADD kicks in too quickly. I'd be running, and almost immediately I'd start thinking about anything and everything that's not running. In fact, I don't like running beyond 60 seconds.

Which means that technically you could do the 400 as well?

Yeah, I could. I mean, I ran a 400m last year too, but I don't see myself running it competitively. If it does